DSEH004 · PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

Segments, Differentiation and Fairness

Week 8 · Lecture 3 · Talent differentiation, i deals, organizational justice and the Round 4 submission

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L3 · SEGMENTS AND FAIRNESS

Differentiation is a promise to some and a message to all

L3 · COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

BT 2026300 is rated 4.5 and may leave. Is it fair to give this engineer a deal no peer is offered?

Fair, unfair, or it depends. If it depends, on what?

L3 · THE CASE FOR DIFFERENTIATION

Exclusive talent management

Proposition

Some positions contribute disproportionately to strategy; invest disproportionately in the people who fill them.

Architecture

Identify pivotal positions, build a talent pool of high potential and high performing people, and differentiate HR to fit.

Critique

Differentiation signals to the excluded majority that they matter less, with justice and morale costs.

At Bharat Textiles

Which roles are pivotal? Collings and Mellahi start from positions, not from the people rated highest.

Collings, D. G., and Mellahi, K. (2009). Strategic talent management: A review and research agenda. Human Resource Management Review, 19(4), 304 to 313

Idiosyncratic deals

Definition

Voluntary, personalized terms of a nonstandard nature, negotiated between an individual and the employer, benefiting both.

Content and timing

Flexibility, development or task content; negotiated at hiring (ex ante) or later (ex post).

Not favoritism

An i deal is open, tied to contribution and mutually beneficial; favoritism is none of these.

The fairness condition

Coworkers accept i deals when the process is transparent and the same chance is open to them.

Rousseau, D. M., Ho, V. T., and Greenberg, J. (2006). I deals: Idiosyncratic terms in employment relationships. Academy of Management Review, 31(4), 977 to 994

Organizational justice: four dimensions and six rules

Colquitt (2001): four dimensions

Dimension	Fairness of
Distributive	Outcomes received
Procedural	Processes that decide them
Interpersonal	Dignity and respect
Informational	Explanations given

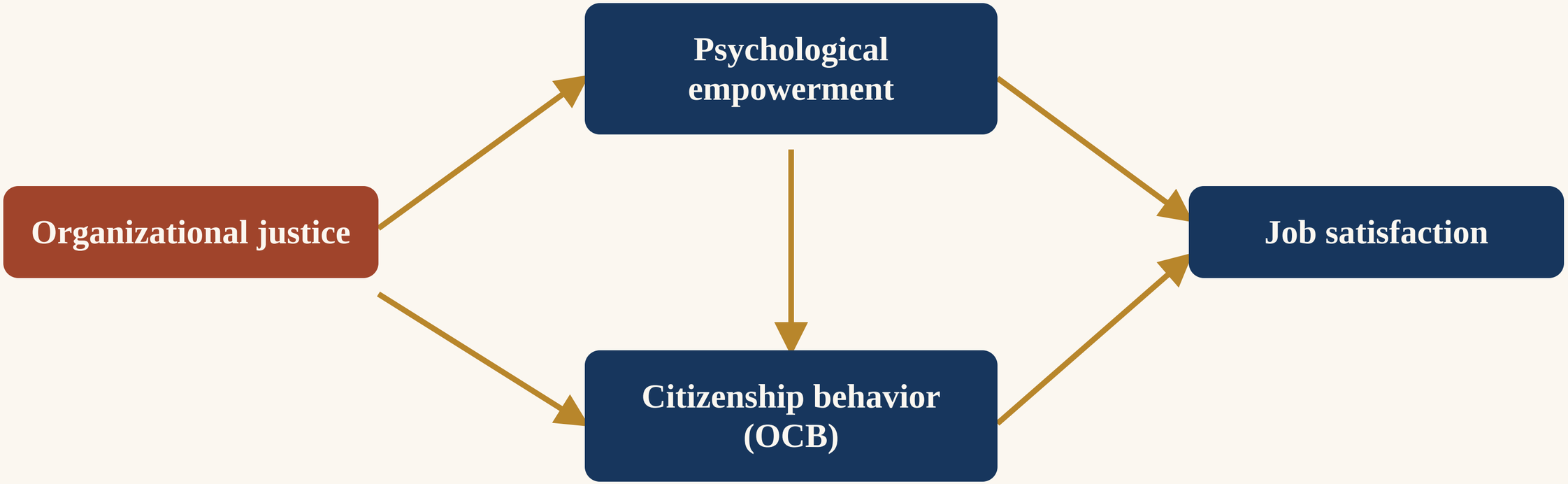
Leventhal (1980): fair procedures are

Consistent · free of bias · accurate · correctable · representative of those affected · ethical

Lind (2001): justice judgments form early and then act as a heuristic for trust.

Colquitt (2001), Journal of Applied Psychology, 86(3), 386 to 400; Leventhal (1980), in Social Exchange, Plenum; Lind (2001), in Advances in Organizational Justice, Stanford University Press

Singh and Singh (2019): how justice pays off



Singh and Singh (2019), Management Decision, 57(4), 937 to 952; survey of Indian employees, structural equation modeling

The segments in the lesson plan, read through theory

Segment	Theory	Mechanism a design must address
Women returners	Kaleidoscope careers	Shifting salience of authenticity, balance and challenge
Contract and gig workers	Nonstandard employment	Outside the employment relationship, survey and justice system
Tier 2 and Tier 3 city staff	Job embeddedness (community)	Strong local links raise the cost of relocation and mobility
High potentials	Exclusive talent management	Pivotal role, not rating; justice for the excluded

Mainiero and Sullivan (2005), Academy of Management Executive, 19(1), 106 to 123; Kalleberg (2000), Annual Review of Sociology, 26, 341 to 365

L3 · STRESS TEST

Two anchors, read through this week's theories

BT 2026100

Gen Z · Sales · 4 months

Socialization: which adjustment indicator is missing?

Unfolding model: what shock would trigger exit?

Fairness heuristic: what has she already concluded?

Theory before label: she is a newcomer first.

BT 2026300

Millennial · Engineering · 3.5 years

Conflicting outcomes: high rating, low wellbeing

I deals: what fair retention terms exist?

Justice: what would peers need to see?

Theory before label: he is a strained performer first.

L3 · ROUND 4 SUBMISSION

Each touchpoint redesign must be theoretically moored

1. The moment, and the theory that makes it matter (socialization, unfolding, embeddedness)
2. The segment, defined by a mechanism, not a label (horizon, stage, life events, community)
3. The prediction: what should change, for whom, if the theory is right
4. The justice test: which of Leventhal's rules could the design break
5. The wellbeing test: which dimension, happiness, health or relationship, it puts at risk

BEFORE WEEK 9

Reflection Log 2, due Sunday: the strongest disagreement in your team across Rounds 1 to 4. Name the theory each side was implicitly using.

Forum: was generational thinking helpful or hindering in Round 4? Which theory from today would have served better?

Quiz 4, Week 9 L1: Weeks 6, 7 and 8. Expect cases where you must tell two or three theories apart.

Prepare: Buckingham and Clifton (2001), Chapter 1; Aguinis, Chapter 8.

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (1 of 3)

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